way. A telephone message was sent to the Duce's palace that I could not come.

T h a t evening I sent a letter to Signor Mussolini expressing my regret that I could not take advantage of his kind invitation to me to see him and thanking him for his message of sympathy.

I continued my journey. At Cairo there were some old friends to meet me, and then further east, over the deserts of Western Asia. Various incidents, and the arrangements necessary for my journey, had so far kept my mind occupied. But after leaving Cairo and flying, hour after hour, over this desolate desert area, a terrible loneliness gripped me and I felt empty and purpose-less. I was going back alone to my home, which was no longer' home for me, and there by my side was a basket and that basket contained an urn. T h a t was all that remained of Kamala, and all our bright dreams were also dead and turned to ashes. She is no more, K a m a l a is no more, my mind kept on repeating.

I thought of my autobiography, that record of my life, which I h a d discussed with her as she lay in Bhowali Sanatorium. And, as I was writing it, sometimes I would take a chapter or two and read it out to her. She had only seen or heard a part of it: she